

STATUS: READY FOR IMPLEMENTATION

Extend the existing Label Station with an in-place Print ID control: default Short SKU (Amazon) keeps today's behavior; UPC (DNK) always prints the retail UPC under the barcode so DNK can match cartons — no second station, route, or catalog.

Problem

Label Station prints the Amazon short SKU under the barcode when catalog sku has ≤7 numeric digits. DNK needs the retail UPC that matches the carton. Staff download the PDF and manually replace short SKU text with UPC. A separate DNK station would work, but is unnecessary if the same tool can switch print ID while keeping the existing scan / catalog / Amazon workflow.

Goal

Add an in-place Print ID mode on the existing Label Station:

- Default = today's short-SKU rule (Amazon)
- Optional = always print retail UPC (DNK)
- Same route, catalog, scan, import, FNSKU barcode
- End manual PDF edits for DNK

Non-goals (v1)

- No second route or nav item
- No duplicate Label Station page
- No schema / External ID column changes
- No Master Sheet / UPC-DIMS changes
- No UPC barcode encoding yet (Mode B later)

Why in-place vs separate station

	In-place Print ID mode	Separate DNK station
Surface area	Smaller — one UI	Larger — route, nav, fork
Amazon default	Explicit default mode	Separate app
Wrong-tool risk	Toggle mistake	Wrong page
Maintenance	One shell	Two shells to sync
Catalog / access	Unchanged	Allowlist + duplicate wiring

Chosen approach: in-place mode on /label-station.

Product decisions (v1)

Decision	Choice
Route	Existing /label-station only
Control	Print ID: Short SKU (Amazon) UPC (DNK)
Default mode	Short SKU / auto — current short-SKU rule
DNK mode	Always print product.upc under barcode
Barcode payload	Still FNSKU in both modes (Mode A)
Persistence	localStorage warehouse_label_id_mode
Catalog	Unchanged warehouse_products
Import / browse	Unchanged on same page
Access / warehouse-only	Unchanged

Optional: reset to Short SKU on each page load so shared station PCs default to Amazon; or keep last choice via localStorage.

Modes at a glance

Mode	Under-barcode text	Everything else
Short SKU (Amazon) — default	Short SKU if ≤ 7 digits, else UPC	Unchanged process
UPC (DNK)	Always retail upc	Same scan, catalog, FNSKU barcode, sizes, printer, import

Data model (unchanged)

Prerequisite: upc must hold the real retail UPC. Amazon short ID / External ID equivalent stays in sku. Rows where upc was overwritten with short SKU must be corrected in catalog data.

Field	Role
upc	Scan key + printed under barcode in UPC (DNK) mode
sku	Printed under barcode in Short SKU mode when ≤ 7 digits
fnsku	Top text + barcode (both modes)
style_name / condition	Unchanged

UX outline

1. Keep existing Label Station title, scan row, quantity, Print / Clear / Preview PDF.
2. Add Print ID control near label size or printer section (radio or segmented control).
3. Labels: Short SKU (Amazon) | UPC (DNK) — default Short SKU.
4. Live size previews and printed / PDF output follow the selected mode.
5. Short helper text: "Use UPC when labels go to DNK for carton match."

6. Catalog import and Product Catalog table unchanged.

Technical design

Core print helper

Extend `getLabelScanLine` in `frontend/src/utils/warehouseLabel.ts` to accept a mode (e.g. 'auto' | 'upc'):

- auto — current short-SKU rule (default)
- upc — always return `product.upc`

Thread the mode through `renderWarehouseLabelCanvas`, `buildWarehouseLabelZpl`, and `buildWarehouseLabelPdfBlob`. Default parameter = auto so any caller without a mode keeps today's behavior.

UI + persistence

In `LabelStation.tsx`: state for print ID mode; `getSelectedLabelIdMode` / `saveSelectedLabelIdMode` with key `warehouse_label_id_mode` (same pattern as size / DPI / printer). Pass mode into preview, ZPL, and PDF paths. Include mode in audit metadata when useful (`label_station.print`).

Docs

Update Job Aids short-SKU FAQ and About Label Station blurb: when sending to DNK, select UPC (DNK).

Backend

None required for v1.

Files to touch

File	Change
warehouseLabel.ts	Mode on <code>getLabelScanLine</code> + canvas / ZPL / PDF; localStorage helpers
LabelStation.tsx	Print ID control; pass mode to preview / print / PDF
JobAids.tsx / About.tsx	Document Short SKU vs UPC (DNK) modes
Tests (optional)	Unit tests: auto prints short SKU; upc mode always prints UPC

Implementation steps

1. Add `LabelIdMode` type + `getLabelScanLine(mode)` with default auto.
2. Pass mode through render / ZPL / PDF helpers (default preserves callers).
3. Add localStorage get/save for `warehouse_label_id_mode`.
4. Wire Print ID UI + preview / print / PDF in `LabelStation.tsx`.
5. Update Job Aids / About.
6. Manual QA: Amazon default unchanged; DNK mode PDF shows UPC; Electron print OK.
7. (Optional) Unit tests for both modes with a short-SKU catalog row.

Test plan

- Default mode + short-SKU row → under-barcode shows short SKU (unchanged)
- Switch to UPC (DNK) + same row → under-barcode shows UPC; barcode still FNSKU
- Long / empty SKU in auto mode still prints UPC (existing rule)
- Scan → Enter auto-print works in both modes (Electron)
- Browser Preview PDF matches selected mode (no hand edit for DNK)
- Size previews update when mode changes
- Mode persists across refresh (if using localStorage) or resets if session-default chosen
- Catalog import / browse / access unchanged
- Warehouse-only and Keepa access paths unchanged

Risks

- Staff leave UPC mode on for Amazon jobs → clear labels; optional session reset to Short SKU
- upc column holds short SKU on some rows → data cleanup
- Mode A insufficient if DNK must scan UPC → Mode B (barcode = UPC) later
- Shared PC localStorage surprise → document + visible mode indicator

Success criteria

- DNK labels show retail UPC without PDF editing
- Default Amazon / short-SKU process unchanged
- No second station, route, or catalog

Follow-ups

- Mode B: UPC barcode when Print ID = UPC
- Session vs persistent default preference
- Auto-map sheets External ID → sku

Relation to separate DNK station summary

An earlier summary proposed a parallel DNK Label Station at /dnk-label-station. This document is the preferred in-place alternative: same DNK outcome (always print UPC text), lower product and maintenance cost, existing Label Station process preserved by default.